

Exponent Laws with Variable Bases

MA.8.AR.1.1

I can multiply and divide monomials, and raise a monomial to a power, by applying the laws of exponents to variable bases.

Warm-Up

1. Find the value: $(2^3)^2 \cdot 2^{-4}$
2. Write as one power: $\frac{6^7}{6^5}$
3. $\sqrt{50}$ is between which two whole numbers?
4. Write with an exponent: $y \cdot y \cdot y \cdot y \cdot y$

Warm-Up

1. Find the value: $(2^3)^2 \cdot 2^{-4}$ **4**
2. Write as one power: $\frac{6^7}{6^5}$ **$6^2 = 36$**
3. $\sqrt{50}$ is between which two whole numbers? **7 and 8**
4. Write with an exponent: $y \cdot y \cdot y \cdot y \cdot y$ **y^5**

Notes

I. Product of powers — the base is a letter now

$$x^2 \cdot x^3 = (x \cdot x)(x \cdot x \cdot x) = x^5 \qquad x^m \cdot x^n = x^{m+n}$$

$$3x^2 \cdot 5x^4 = (3 \cdot 5)(x^2 \cdot x^4) = 15x^6$$

Multiply the coefficients. Add the exponents of like bases.

Different variables stay separate: $x^2y \cdot x^3y^4 = x^5y^5$

Notes

II. Power of a power, power of a product

$$(x^3)^4 = x^3 \cdot x^3 \cdot x^3 \cdot x^3 = x^{12}$$

$$(x^m)^n = x^{mn}$$

$$(2y^2)^3 = 2^3 \cdot (y^2)^3 = 8y^6$$

$$(15xy^2)^3 = 3,375x^3y^6$$

Power of a power: multiply the exponents. Power of a product: raise every factor.

Notes

III. Quotient of powers — dividing monomials

$$\frac{x^7}{x^2} = \frac{x \cdot x \cdot x \cdot x \cdot x \cdot x \cdot x}{x \cdot x} = x^5$$

$$\frac{x^m}{x^n} = x^{m-n}$$

$$\frac{12a^5}{4a^2} = 3a^3$$

$$\frac{m^6n^4}{m^2n^4} = m^4n^0 = m^4$$

Divide the coefficients. Subtract the exponents of like bases.

Example 1

$$(4x^3y)(-2x^2y^5)$$

Write an equivalent expression as a single monomial.

Example 1

$$\begin{aligned}(4x^3y)(-2x^2y^5) &= (4)(-2) \cdot x^3x^2 \cdot y^1y^5 \\ &= -8 \cdot x^5 \cdot y^6 = -8x^5y^6\end{aligned}$$

Answer: $-8x^5y^6$

Your Turn

$$(5a^2b^4)(3ab^2)$$

Write an equivalent expression as a single monomial.

Your Turn

$$(5a^2b^4)(3ab^2)$$

Write an equivalent expression as a single monomial.

Answer: $15a^3b^6$

Example 2

$$\frac{(3m^2n)^3}{9m^4n}$$

Write an equivalent expression as a single monomial.

Example 2

$$(3m^2n)^3 = 27m^6n^3$$

$$\frac{27m^6n^3}{9m^4n} = 3 \cdot m^{6-4} \cdot n^{3-1} = 3m^2n^2$$

Answer: $3m^2n^2$

Your Turn

$$\frac{(2p^3)^4}{8p^5}$$

Write an equivalent expression as a single monomial.

Your Turn

$$\frac{(2p^3)^4}{8p^5}$$

Write an equivalent expression as a single monomial.

Answer: $2p^7$

Whiteboards • Question 1 of 9

$$x^5 \cdot x^8$$

Answer it.

Whiteboards • Question 1 of 9

$$x^5 \cdot x^8$$

Answer: x^{13}

Whiteboards · Question 2 of 9

$$(y^4)^3$$

Answer it.

Whiteboards • Question 2 of 9

$$(y^4)^3$$

Answer: y^{12}

Whiteboards • Question 3 of 9

A cube has edges $2x^3$ centimeters long.

Its surface area is $24x^6$ square centimeters.

What is the volume of the cube, in cubic centimeters?

Answer it.

Whiteboards • Question 3 of 9

A cube has edges $2x^3$ centimeters long.

Its surface area is $24x^6$ square centimeters.

What is the volume of the cube, in cubic centimeters?

Answer: $8x^9$

Whiteboards • Question 4 of 9

$$(3a^2b)(4ab^5)$$

Answer it.

Whiteboards • Question 4 of 9

$$(3a^2b)(4ab^5)$$

Answer: $12a^3b^6$

Whiteboards · Question 5 of 9

$$(5m^3)^2$$

Which expression is equivalent?

A. $25m^6$

B. $10m^6$

C. $25m^5$

D. $5m^6$

Answer it.

Whiteboards • Question 5 of 9

$$(5m^3)^2$$

Which expression is equivalent?

A. $25m^6$

B. $10m^6$

C. $25m^5$

D. $5m^6$

Answer: A — $25m^6$

Whiteboards • Question 6 of 9

$$\frac{12x^8}{3x^2}$$

Which expression is equivalent?

A. $4x^{10}$

B. $4x^6$

C. $9x^6$

D. $4x^4$

Answer it.

Whiteboards • Question 6 of 9

$$\frac{12x^8}{3x^2}$$

Which expression is equivalent?

A. $4x^{10}$

B. $4x^6$

C. $9x^6$

D. $4x^4$

Answer: B — $4x^6$

Whiteboards • Question 7 of 9

$$\frac{m^6 n^4}{m^2 n^4}$$

Answer it.

Whiteboards • Question 7 of 9

$$\frac{m^6 n^4}{m^2 n^4}$$

Answer: m^4

Whiteboards • Question 8 of 9

Find the value of n :

$$x^3 \cdot x^n = x^{11}$$

Answer it.

Whiteboards • Question 8 of 9

Find the value of n :

$$x^3 \cdot x^n = x^{11}$$

Answer: $n = 8$

Whiteboards • Question 9 of 9

Rachel writes $(15xy^2)^3$ as $15 \cdot 15 \cdot 15 \cdot x \cdot x \cdot x \cdot y \cdot y \cdot y \cdot y \cdot y \cdot y$.

Justina writes it as $3,375x^3y^6$. Who is correct? Explain.

Write your answer in sentences.

Whiteboards • Question 9 of 9

Rachel writes $(15xy^2)^3$ as $15 \cdot 15 \cdot 15 \cdot x \cdot x \cdot x \cdot y \cdot y \cdot y \cdot y \cdot y \cdot y$.

Justina writes it as $3,375x^3y^6$. Who is correct? Explain.

Answer: Both are correct; $15^3 = 3,375$, $x \cdot x \cdot x = x^3$, and six y's make y^6 .

Independent Set

1. Six questions. Work down the page.
2. Show the step that does the work, not just the answer.
3. Silence until the six minutes are up.

IXL

1. Open IXL and start today's skills.
2. Work on paper where the question needs work. The answer box does not show it.
3. Every skill listed is required, to a SmartScore of 67. Due at the start of the next class.

Today's skills — all required

Multiply powers: variable bases — TR9

Powers of a power: variable bases — 2CU

Divide monomials with positive exponents — C8L